

ISAAC (ZAC) ADJEI

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[Date]

[Hiring Manager Name/Recruitment Team]

[Company Name]

[Company Address/Location]

Dear [Hiring Manager Name/Recruitment Team] ,

I am writing to apply for the [Role Title] position at [Company Name] . As an Electronic Engineering and Computer Science student at Aston University (Predicted First Class) and Top 40 Finalist in the Black Heritage Undergraduate of the Year Award 2026, I design security into systems from the first line: not as a bolt-on after functionality is working, but as a constraint that shapes every architectural decision.

My most security-intensive project is AstonCV, a full-stack CV and application management system deployed live on Aston University servers, built from scratch in PHP 8.2 with MySQL. I implemented 12+ security controls without relying on any security framework: JWT-based authentication with asymmetric keys, role-based access control separating student and admin permissions, CSRF token validation on every state-changing request, brute-force lockout with exponential backoff after five failed attempts, bcrypt hashing for all credentials, mPDF generation sandboxed to prevent path traversal, prepared statements throughout and Content Security Policy, X-Frame-Options and Referrer-Policy headers enforced on every response. The threat model informed every feature decision; I wrote it before I wrote the first route handler. In my personal portfolio dashboard I layer defence in depth across a different stack: a NextAuth GitHub OAuth gate, a PIN lock cookie (httpOnly, SameSite=Strict, bcrypt hash in Supabase) for the most sensitive sections, per-IP rate limiting on public API routes via Upstash Redis, CSRF-equivalent protections on server actions, Gitleaks secret scanning on every push and security headers managed through Cloudflare. I am drawn to [Company Name] because of [specific reason] and I am keen to contribute to [specific security challenge or product area] .

Security thinking applies differently across the stack but the core question is always the same: what does an attacker gain if this assumption is wrong? I apply that question to auth flows, input validation boundaries, secret management and third-party integrations alike. I also have experience working with IoT attack surfaces: PHAEMOS exposes authenticated FastAPI endpoints to ESP32 nodes, and I designed the JWT validation and anomaly detection alerting to be robust against malformed payloads and replay attempts. My hardware background adds a further layer of perspective: I understand how physical access, firmware update paths and UART debug interfaces create attack surfaces that software-only engineers often overlook.

I am looking for a team that takes security seriously from the design stage. [Company Name] 's work on [specific security challenge or area] is exactly the kind of environment where I want to develop my skills, and I would bring both the technical depth and the defensive instincts the role requires.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome a conversation about how I can contribute to [Company Name] 's security engineering work.

Yours sincerely,

Isaac (Zac) Adjei